

Alternatives

Simplenote (simple-note.appspot.com) has a clean interface for writing notes, but its real strength is being able to sync its contents to the Web wirelessly. When you make changes, they're reflected at the Web site and on other devices you use that run Simplenote (such as the iPhone). You don't have to wait to sync over the dock connection cable to get the notes on my computer. For more bells and whistles, check out Evernote (www.evernote.com), a catchall app and web service that can store text, images, and audio for later.

Use the camera for photos and videos

Taking still photos

To shoot a digital photo, make sure you set the little slider in the bottom-right corner to (still camera). Line up your shot and press the shutter button. Your newly snapped picture ends up in **Photos > Camera Roll**. A preview of the last shot you snapped also appears in the bottom-left corner of the screen; tap it to jump right to the photo in the Camera Roll album. Tapping the screen to readjust the photo's exposure also brings up the zoom slider (right). If you want to narrow in on your subject and lose distracting background elements, tap the screen and drag the slider to the right until you have the framing you want. Drag the slider the other way to zoom back out. To change cameras and take a self-portrait with the front camera, tap the Switch Cameras icon (Z) in the upper-right corner of the photo screen.

Shooting videos

To shoot a video, tap the Camera icon on the Home screen and nudge the slider over to (video). It flashes red to indicate that you're recording. The time stamp in the upper-right corner of the screen shows the current length of your video-in-progress. Like the still camera, you can tap an area of the screen to adjust the exposure, but there's no zoom feature for video.

Share and upload photos and videos

Now that you've taken all these great photos and videos, don't you want to share them? You can do that in several ways:

- ▶ **Email:** Tap **Photos > Camera Roll** to see your photos and videos; if you have the Camera app open onscreen, tap the thumbnail preview icon in the toolbar to jump to your collection. Next tap the thumbnails of the photos and videos you want to send, and then tap Email. A mail message